

How BATTERIES MANUFACTURE Can BOOST BUSINESSES

Battery Tech Show 2021 Panel Discussion: Battery, a critical component, is not something novel for India as it already has a mature market for lead-acid batteries. Currently, India is import dependent for battery cells, and this calls for a robust domestic battery manufacturing infrastructure with focus on ecosystem development and conducive policy environment



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India's massive and diverse transport sector is now adopting sustainable mobility solutions like electric vehicles (EVs). It is one among the few countries driving a shift away from traditional fuel based transportation systems with priority towards environmental goals.

The good news is, now we have more EV models, battery technologies, chemistries, storage systems, manufacturing hubs, and charging infrastructure than ever before. This is motivating manufacturers to consider turning the country into a global manufacturing hub for bat-

teries. However, there are barriers as well as opportunities to be considered.

Earlier, if we look at the dry-cell battery usage, we used to see it in small gadgets like cameras, laptops, and smartphones. But now their usage is migrating to EVs as well and the entire dynamics and requirement of the battery is changing. So, we need to look at what chemistry is used in batteries, heat generation, long lasting efficiency, and even recycling concepts.

Piyush Gupta, CEO, Lithion Power, says his company focuses on battery swapping and energy delivery for 2-wheelers and 3-wheelers that are largely operational in northern India at this point in time. With core focus around low- and medium-speed vehicles, he operates a network of battery swap stations for e-commerce companies using EV fleets for delivery.

"While we specialise in battery swapping, we are under no illusion that battery swapping is the only thing that is going to work. We believe in omni charging, and our technology allows people to charge at home, public charging infrastructures, or to do swapping, as is required to increase the customer range."

Supratim Naskar, Co-founder and CTO, Cell Propulsion, says his EV mobility technology company focuses on commercial vehicle segment. Being in the B2B market, they develop solutions built on the entire technology stack—the hardware, battery pack, battery management system, motors, drives, all the way up to supporting software for a complete ecosystem. "We deploy our vehicles under operation with our cus-